THE 90-DAY
FIRST DEAL BLUEPRINT

How to Close Your First Real Estate Deal Without a Bank,
Perfect Credit, or Quitting Your Day Job

By Ron Breitenbach

Real Estate Investor Since 2010 · Part of a 40,000+ Investor Network

The same framework used by Ron's students to close deals in under 90 days.

Before We Get Into It

You've done the research. You know real estate is the vehicle. Maybe you've been to a seminar. Maybe you've read a book or two. Maybe you've watched more YouTube videos on wholesaling and fix-and-flip than you'd like to admit.

You're not confused about the destination — or maybe you are? What you don't have is a blueprint. Not a strategy — a blueprint. Something that tells you what to do on Monday. Who to call on Tuesday. What online trainings to attend with others. What kind of offer to make on Thursday. Without that, getting ready becomes a full-time hobby that never pays anything.

I closed my first wholesale deal without a bank, without a real estate license, and without quitting my day job. And without any of my own money — I borrowed it! I give every new student the same homework I followed myself: make ten offers this week. This guide is that homework, in writing, for your exact situation.

> *"You're gonna fumble in your words. You're gonna not know exactly what to say. That's fine. I was there too. You gotta just get started."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

90-Day Challenge Yourself Blueprint — In this guide, you will discover:

✓ The exact 90-day timeline broken into weeks — so you always know what to do next and never waste a day on the wrong thing

✓ How to close your first wholesale deal without putting a single dollar of your own money on the line — the way most first deals actually happen

✓ The 7 platforms where motivated sellers are hiding right now — including ones most beginners completely ignore

✓ The three conversations to have this week that put you on every serious investor's radar in your market

✓ The LLC structure rule that protects every deal you close — the mistake that cost one couple Ron knows every single one of their 14 properties

✓ Ron's exact homework assignment — the one that produced a $14,000 payday in week three for a student who had never done a deal before

Section 1: The ‘Getting Ready’ Trap

There’s a specific kind of investor I see all the time. They’re motivated. They’re smart. They genuinely want to change their financial situation. They’ve been ‘getting ready’ for 1, 2, sometimes 3 years.

And they haven’t made a single offer. Or found a Mentor.

Not because they don’t have the information. They have too much information. They’ve read about wholesaling, fix and flip, buy and hold, BRRRR, subject-to, seller financing, hard money, private money, Bigger Pockets. They know the vocabulary. They know the strategies. And all that knowledge is sitting in their head doing absolutely nothing while the market moves without them.

Getting ready feels like progress. It isn’t. Progress is a submitted offer. Progress is a motivated seller conversation. Progress is a walk-through of a distressed property. Everything else is preparation — and at some point, preparation without action becomes avoidance. “You make money when you buy, not when you sell.”

> *“I don’t care how much you know. I care how many offers you made this week. Get off the couch and social media — unless you’re using it to find people and property leads.”*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

The Real Cost of Waiting

Here’s a number that should move you: every year you delay starting your real estate investing, you are not standing still. IDOL. You are actively falling behind.

Every year of delay is a year of appreciation you didn’t capture. A year of rent checks you didn’t collect. A year of equity you didn’t build. A year of experience you don’t have when you’re finally ready.

The cost of a mistake as a beginner is low. You make a bad offer and it doesn’t get accepted. You walk a property and it doesn’t work out. You learn something and you go again. It’s called learning. The cost of not starting is much higher. You look back in 5 years and realize that the only thing standing between you and 5 deals was the decision to begin.

The Research Trap vs. The Action Path

Research Trap: 2 years of videos, books, and seminars — 0 deals, 0 income, 0 experience
Action Path: 90 days of offers, calls, and walkthroughs — 1 deal, real income, real skill
The only difference is the willingness to start before you feel completely ready.
You will never feel completely ready. That's normal. Go anyway.

What This Blueprint Changes

This guide eliminates the excuse of not knowing what to do next. By the time you finish it, every week of the next 90 days has a clear target. You will know who to call, what to search for, how to run the numbers, and exactly what 'making an offer' looks like in practice (practice, practice, practice).

The only thing left after you read this is whether you'll get off the couch and do it. I can give you the blueprint. I can't give you the determination. That part's on you. But if you've got it — if you're really done sitting on the sidelines — this is the guide that gets you to your first deal.

Section 2: How to Close Without a Bank

Most people assume you need a bank loan to invest in real estate. You don't. In fact, the most common way new investors close their first deal doesn't involve a bank at all. It's called wholesaling — and I'm going to explain it in plain language.

What Wholesaling Actually Is

Wholesaling is a three-step process. Step one: you find a distressed property with a motivated seller who wants to sell below market value. Step two: you get that property under contract — you agree on a price with the seller and sign a purchase agreement. Step three: before you close, you find another investor who wants to buy the property, and you assign your contract to them for a fee.

You never own the property. You never get a bank loan. You never need perfect credit. The assignment fee — the difference between your contract price and the price the end buyer pays — is your income. It can range from $3,000 to $25,000+* per deal, depending on the market and the spread you negotiated.

How a Wholesale Deal Works — Simple Example

You find a distressed property. Seller wants out. Fair market value: $250,000.
You get it under contract for $175,000 (motivated seller accepts).
You find an investor-buyer who will pay $190,000 for it.
You assign your contract to them for the $15,000 difference.
Seller gets their $175,000. Buyer gets a deal. You get $15,000.
No bank. No credit check. No renovation. No ownership.

Why Motivated Sellers Say Yes

The key to wholesale is understanding the motivated seller. These are not people who want to give away their property. They are people who have a problem that needs to be solved fast — and speed and certainty are worth more to them than maximum price.

Maybe they're going through a divorce. Maybe they inherited a property they don't want. Maybe they're behind on payments and facing foreclosure. Maybe they're a landlord who is exhausted and just wants out. In every case, they have a problem. You are offering a solution: fast, certain, cash.

You are not taking advantage of them. You are solving a real problem. They couldn't sell on the open market fast enough for the price they needed, and you gave them a way out. That is a real service.

> *"It doesn't have to be your credit. It doesn't have to be your capital. But it has to be your hustle."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

The Wholesale Mindset Shift

The biggest barrier to wholesaling is psychological. You're going to make offers on properties you can't afford to buy. That feels uncomfortable at first. Get comfortable with it. You are an intermediary, and being an intermediary is a legitimate, valuable, and profitable role in every major market.

The second barrier is fear of conversation. You have to talk to sellers, talk to agents, talk to buyers. You're going to fumble your words early on. That's normal. I did too. Every investor did. The only way through it is through it — and each conversation makes the next one easier.

Section 3: Where to Find Motivated Sellers

Motivated sellers are everywhere. They are not hiding. You just have to know where to look and what signals to watch for. Here are the seven sources I tell every new investor to work from day one.

Source 1: Realtor.com

This is my personal first stop. Filter for price reductions, high days on market (60+ days is a strong signal), and 'as-is' listings. A property that's been sitting is a motivated seller. A price reduction is a motivated seller waving a flag. These are your targets. (Learn what the red flags are in real estate!)

Source 2: Zillow.com

Set up search alerts in your target zip codes. Watch for 'price reduced' tags and filter for properties with long days on market. Zillow also shows Zestimate vs. listing price gaps — properties priced significantly below Zestimate can be gold.

Source 3: Offerpad

This is one most beginners skip entirely. Offerpad has a pool of frustrated owners — people who have been trying to rent or sell a property for months and haven't been able to. That frustration creates opportunity. Go to Offerpad, find the properties that have been sitting, and reach out. These are highly motivated sellers.

Source 4: Facebook Marketplace

Search 'handyman special', 'as-is', 'cash only', 'needs work', and 'fixer upper' in your target area. Facebook Marketplace is full of off-market deals from sellers who don't want the hassle of listing on the MLS. Some of the best wholesale opportunities I've seen have come through here.

Source 5: Craigslist

People keep declaring Craigslist dead. It keeps producing deals. Search 'for sale by owner', 'cash sale', 'motivated seller', and 'sell fast' in your target market. It takes 15 minutes a day and occasionally produces a deal that's not listed anywhere else.

Source 6: Google Search

Type these searches directly into Google: ‘distressed property [your city]’, ‘motivated seller [your city]’, ‘sell my house fast [your city]’, and ‘we buy houses [your city]’. The ‘we buy houses’ searches will show you other wholesalers active in your market — call them. They’re potential buyers for deals you find.

Source 7: Driving for Dollars

Old school. Still works. Drive through your target neighborhood and look for distressed, neglected, or vacant properties. Note the addresses. Then look up the owner through your county tax records website — most counties have this free online. Send a hand-written letter or call them directly. Some of the best off-market deals start with a $0.50 stamp (or more).

How to approach agents when you call:

“I’m a real estate investor looking in [area]. I work with distressed properties and I move fast. I’m looking for properties that need work or that have been sitting. Do you work with investors?”

That’s it. Simple. Direct. It tells them you’re serious, you’re specific, and you’re not wasting their time.

OpenDoor will sometimes give investors access codes to walk properties they’re listing. Use this. Go walk every property you can. Wear clothes you don’t mind getting dirty. Good shoes. Some will be clean and easy. Some will need real work. You need to see both to understand your market.

Text the word SUMMIT to get started:

https://wa.me/15203437331?text=SUMMIT

Section 4: Your Week-by-Week 90-Day Roadmap

This is the blueprint. Not a strategy — a blueprint. Each phase has specific targets. Each week has specific actions. Your only job is to work through it consistently.

Print this section. Give yourself a deadline for each phase. Check things off as you complete them. The investors who treat this like homework close deals. The ones who treat it like a reading assignment stay in research mode.

Phase 1 — Weeks 1–2: Build the Foundation

Before you look at a single property, complete these actions. Non-negotiable. They protect you legally and set you up for every move that follows.

Weeks 1–2 — Week 1 Targets

Legal and Financial Setup

Talk to a real estate attorney in your state. Get your LLC set up before deal one. See Section 6 for exactly why this is urgent.

Call a mortgage broker. Ask: 'What's the max FHA loan for a single-family home and a four-plex in my target county?' Write down that number. It's your market ceiling for every deal you evaluate.

Create accounts on realtor.com, zillow.com, and Offerpad. Set search alerts for your target zip codes for price-reduced, long-DOM, and as-is listings.

Join a local real estate investor association (REIA). Find the next meeting date and go. Introduce yourself to at least three people.

Weeks 1–2 — Week 2 Targets

Market Research and Property Radar

Research average sold prices in your target zip codes. What does a standard 3BR/2BA sell for? What's the distressed discount in your area?

Research average rents. What does a 3BR/2BA rent for in your target market? What about a four-plex unit?

Start your property tracking spreadsheet: address, asking price, days on market, estimated condition, potential offer range.

Target: 10 properties on your radar by end of week 2.

Phase 2 — Weeks 3–4: First Conversations

Phase 2 is about activating your network and building your relationships. These are the conversations that make deals possible — because in real estate, most deals come through people, not platforms.

Weeks 3–4 Targets

Build Your Inner Circle

Call at least 3 real estate agents who work with investors. Use the script from Section 3. Ask if they have any pocket listings or properties that haven't hit the market yet.

Reach out to 2 wholesalers active in your target market (find them via Google or the REIA). Let them know you're buying. They'll start sending you deals.

Connect with a hard money lender even if you don't need them yet. Know what your financing options look like for when a fix-and-flip opportunity shows up.

Target: 20 properties on your radar by end of week 4. Continue searching daily across all 7 sources from Section 3.

Target: Make your first 5 offers by end of week 4 — even if they feel low. Get comfortable with the process.

Phase 3 — Weeks 5–8: The Offer Machine

This is the phase that separates investors who close deals from investors who stay stuck. The target is simple and non-negotiable.

Make 10 offers this week.

Then make 10 more next week. And 10 the week after that. And 10 the week after that.

40 offers over 4 weeks. By week 8, you will have had real conversations, real counter-offers, and at least one deal in motion.

Here is how to run the numbers before every offer. For wholesale: what would another investor pay for this property in its current condition? That's your end buyer's price. Subtract your desired assignment fee ($5,000–$15,000*). What's left is your maximum contract price. That's what you offer.

For buy and hold: what does the property rent for? What are your financing costs, insurance, taxes, and maintenance? What is your net monthly cash flow? If it's positive and you can get into it at the right price, make the offer.

For fix and flip: what is the after-repair value (ARV)? What are the renovation costs? Subtract both from the ARV, then subtract your profit target. What's left is your maximum offer. Never budge above that number no matter how much you like the house.

Weeks 5–8 — The Walk-Through Protocol

Walk every property before you offer. Call the agent: 'I'm an investor. I'd like to walk through this property.' Or use an OpenDoor access code. Go walk it.

Wear clothes you don't mind getting dirty. Good shoes. Some properties will be clean. Some will need a gut renovation. Be prepared for both without reacting emotionally to either. You are evaluating math, not judging a property.

Make notes on condition: roof, foundation, HVAC, plumbing, windows, flooring, kitchen, bathrooms. You're not doing a full inspection yet — you're doing a quick condition assessment to estimate renovation scope and cost.

Phase 4 — Weeks 9–12: Your First Deal Closes

By week nine, with 10+ offers per week for four weeks, you have made over 40 offers. Some got rejected. Some counter-offered. One or two are in serious discussion or have accepted your price.

Weeks 9–12 Targets

Close the Deal

For wholesale: conduct due diligence, confirm your end buyer is locked in, assign the contract, and collect your fee. The average first wholesale assignment fee is $5,000–$20,000.

For buy and hold: complete your property inspection, finalize financing, and close. Get a tenant into the property as fast as possible after closing.

For fix and flip: complete your inspection, finalize hard money or private money financing, close, and immediately begin renovation with your contractor.

Document everything: what worked, what you would do differently, what you learned about your market. Your second deal will be better because of this one.

Call the next 10 people on your motivated seller list. The deal machine doesn't stop after deal one.

Your first deal will not be perfect. It doesn’t need to be. Done is better than perfect. The experience of closing deal one teaches you more in four weeks than four months of reading. Get it done, learn from it, and do the next one.

Section 5: The Three Conversations to Have This Week

You don't need to wait until you've finished reading this guide to start building your investing network. These three conversations can happen this week. They cost you nothing. And they will teach you more about your specific market than any course or book.

Conversation 1

A Mortgage Broker

Call a mortgage broker and ask two questions: What is the maximum FHA loan for a single-family home in my target county? And what is the maximum for a four-plex? These numbers define the top of your market for FHA-eligible buyers — which is most of the market. You need to know them before you evaluate a single deal.

Conversation 2

A Real Estate Agent Who Works With Investors

Call at least three agents this week. Use this script: 'I'm an investor looking for distressed properties in [area]. I move fast and I close. Do you work with investors?' Find one who does. They become a key asset — they'll call you first when something comes up that fits your criteria.

Conversation 3

A Real Estate Attorney

Call a real estate attorney in your state before you close a single deal. This conversation is about getting your LLC set up properly and understanding your state's specific laws around real estate investing — especially landlord-tenant law, wholesale assignment legality, and asset protection. Don't copy another state's structure. Get local advice.

These conversations take 1–2 hours total across your week. The knowledge and relationships they create will last your entire investing career. No blog post, no YouTube video, no book replaces them. Pick up the phone.

Text the word SUMMIT to get started:

https://wa.me/15203437331?text=SUMMIT

Section 6: The LLC Rule — Before You Close Deal One

This section is not exciting. There are no strategies, no scripts, no numbers to run. But it may be the most important section in this guide. Because every investor who has lost everything — or lost a lot — has had one thing in common: they didn't have the right structure in place before they needed it.

The Story You Need to Hear

I know a couple in Arizona. They were building a real estate portfolio. Doing good deals. Accumulating properties. But their entity structure wasn't right. Every property they owned was held in a way that exposed them to liability.

Then came a lawsuit. One judgment. And because their assets weren't protected through the right entity structure, that judgment cascaded across every property they owned.

They lost 14 homes.

> *"Fourteen homes. Not because they made bad deals. Because they didn't have the right structure protecting those deals. Don't let that be your story."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

The protection is simple. It is not expensive. A real estate attorney can help you set up the right structure for your investing strategy in your state in a matter of days. The cost of not doing it can be everything you build.

What to Do Before Deal One

1. Consult a real estate attorney in your state. LLC rules and asset protection structures vary significantly by state. Get advice specific to where you are investing.
2. Set up the right entity before you close. Not after your first deal. Before it. If you're wholesaling, this looks different than if you're building a rental portfolio. Your attorney will guide you.
3. Never hold property in your personal name. Every asset should be in the appropriate entity. Without exception.
4. Ask about umbrella insurance as a secondary layer of protection. Great attorneys build layered protection. One LLC is a start. An umbrella policy makes it more robust.

The Non-Negotiable Rule

LLC is set up before deal one. Not after. Before.

Every asset goes in the right entity. No exceptions.

Know your state's specific laws. Do not copy another state's structure.

Review your structure with your attorney every year as your portfolio grows.

This is the cost of playing the game. Treat it like the priority it is.

Section 7: Ron's Homework Assignment

I give every new investor I work with the same homework. Not a list of concepts to study. Not a checklist of things to research. Actual homework with actual targets and an actual deadline.

Here it is — the challenge yourself, go for it:

Make 10 offers this week.

Real offers. Submitted in writing. On actual properties.

Not 'thinking about making offers.' Not 'looking at properties.' Actual written offers, submitted.

Why 10 Offers?

Because one offer teaches you nothing. Ten offers in one week teaches you how agents talk to you, how sellers respond, what your market accepts, what gets rejected, and exactly how far you need to go to find the deal. You learn more in one week of making offers than in six months of watching other investors talk about making offers.

Most of them will get rejected. That's not failure. That's data. Every rejection tells you something about price expectations, seller motivation levels, and where deals actually happen in your market. Each no brings you closer to the yes.

The Student Who Made $14,000* in Week Three

One of my students — zero experience, zero real estate background, modest capital — started with this exact homework. Week one: she made 10 offers. She didn't know exactly what she was doing. She fumbled her words with two agents. But she submitted the offers.

Week two: two of those offers came back with counter-offers. She negotiated one of them. She put it under contract.

Week three: she assigned that contract to an investor buyer in her network for a $14,000* assignment fee.

She didn't know everything about real estate. She didn't have perfect credit or private capital. She had a niche, a blueprint, and she did the homework. That's how this works.

Your Homework Starts Now

Not after you finish the guide. Not after you set up your LLC. Not after you have everything perfectly in place.

Right now. Today. This week.

Go to realtor.com. Search for distressed properties in your target area. Find 10 properties that could work for your niche. Run the numbers. Make the offers. Call the agents. Have the conversations.

You're going to fumble some of it. That's part of the process. I did too. Every investor you admire did too. The only difference between the investors who close deals and the ones who don't is that the successful ones started before they were ready. Get started.

What You Just Learned — And What Comes Next

Let's take stock of where you are after reading this guide.

- You understand exactly why 'getting ready' is a trap — and why starting before you're ready is the only path forward.
- You know how wholesale works — and why it's the most accessible first deal for investors without significant capital.
- You have 7 sources of motivated sellers — and you know how to approach agents in a way that gets results.
- You have a week-by-week, 90-day roadmap — so the next 90 days have clear targets for every phase.
- You know the three conversations to have this week — mortgage broker, investor-friendly agent, real estate attorney.
- You know the LLC protection rule — and why it must happen before deal one, not after.
- You have your homework assignment — make 10 offers this week.

Here's the Problem This Blueprint Just Created

You have the blueprint. You know the steps. You know where to look and how to run the numbers and what the homework is. That's real.

But here's the thing about blueprints: they work in general. They don't know your specific market, your specific income situation, your specific risk tolerance, or the specific property you're looking at right now. A blueprint tells you how to build the house. It doesn't tell you whether to build it on this lot or that one. Whether the foundation requires extra work. Whether this neighborhood is about to turn or already peaked.

There's also the moment every new investor hits where something unexpected comes up and they don't know if they should walk away or push through. That moment will come for you. And when it does, reading a guide isn't enough. You need someone who's been there to talk it through with you in real time.

That's what 15 years of investing experience is for. And that's what a 20-minute strategy call is for.

The Call That Gives You the Missing Piece

I take five free strategy calls per week. On the call, I look at your situation — your market, your Investor ID, your timeline, your specific first deal — and I give you the exact first three moves for your situation. Not the blueprint. Your moves. Built around your actual life.

I've been doing this for 15 years. I don't have a team of closers calling you back. I pick up the phone myself. I don't sugarcoat things. You'll leave the call with a personalized homework assignment and more clarity than you'd get from another year of research.

No pitch. No obligation. Just your roadmap.

Book your free 20-minute Strategy Call with Ron.

5 slots per week. Ron reviews your situation personally on every call.

Even if you're not ready. Especially if you're not ready.

Text the word SUMMIT to get started:

https://wa.me/15203437331?text=SUMMIT

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